HACK876 × THE AMERICAN FRIENDS OF JAMAICA

PRIVATE PARTNERSHIP PROPOSAL

Opportunity needs a first step.

AFJ's leadership describes education and innovation as a pathway to opportunity. Hack876 gives young Jamaicans one day to take their first step down it.

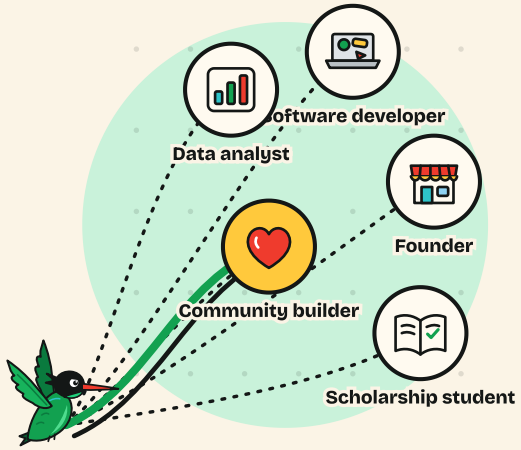
Kingston, Jamaica · Feb 20, 2027 (tentative)



80	9	1
STUDENTS	SCHOOL NETWORK	DAY

One day to build something that should exist.

What if young Jamaicans experienced themselves as builders before anyone told them what career they should have?



Before the degree.

Before the first job.

Before anyone hands them a title.

There is usually a first moment when someone realizes: I can build this.

For most young people, that moment arrives late, if it arrives at all.

Hack876 is designed to create more of those moments.

Meet Hack876.



Hack876 is a one-day build competition for approximately **80 secondary-school students** from 5th Form through Upper 6th Form, working in teams of 3 to 4, roughly 20 teams in all, on Saturday, February 20, 2027 (tentative).

Teams pick a real problem, use modern tools including AI, get guidance from mentors, and finish the day with a working prototype and a pitch to judges. It is not a school assignment and there is no answer key.

Our **9-school network** in Kingston is made up of the schools where the Hack876 team currently has relationships and can coordinate most reliably. It is not an exclusive eligibility list.

BUILD SOMETHING THAT SHOULD EXIST.

03 NOT JUST APPS

A hackathon is bigger than software.

Hack876 is an open build competition. Teams choose the problem and the medium.

Some will write code. Some will wire circuits. Some will design a service, a business or a tool nobody has thought of yet.

A team might build:

- A piece of software
- An AI tool
- An automation
- A data product
- A tool for small businesses
- Hardware
- A robot
- A physical prototype
- A resilience solution
- Something none of us expected

The medium does not matter.

The instinct to create does.

Why The American Friends of Jamaica

Hack876 is one day where tutoring, job readiness and a first working build meet in the same room.

AFJ'S MISSION

“The American Friends of Jamaica is a not-for-profit 501(c)(3) organization dedicated to support Jamaican charitable organizations and social initiatives committed to sustainably transforming the lives of Jamaicans.”[2]

AFJ looks for organisations with "measurable impact, an efficient track record and excellence."[3]

Its education grants already reach tutoring for secondary school students and job training programmes.[3]

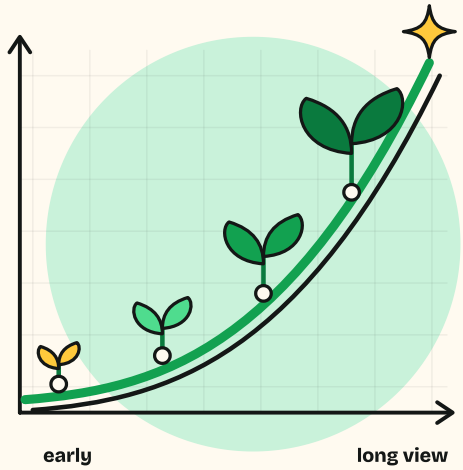
Economic development grants are weighed on their potential for job readiness and job creation.[3]

In 2025 an AFJ grant made the Coding Challenge 2025 free for students in grades 4 to 12, alongside a robotics outreach day.[4]

"At AFJ, we believe in investing in education and innovation as a pathway to opportunity, equity, and empowerment for all." Monica Ladd, AFJ[4]

Four decades of believing in Jamaica.

1982	Founded by a handful of Jamaicans and Americans who loved Jamaica and wanted to see it prosper.[2]
Since 1982	About US$20.4 million in grants across education, healthcare and economic development.[3]
2025	A dedicated grant makes a national coding challenge free for students in grades 4 to 12.[4]
2026	US$1.3 million to 65 organisations, presented at the United States Embassy.[5]
Every November	A new grant cycle opens, with applications due the first Friday in February.[6]



Every cycle, AFJ backs the organisations doing the work. Hack876 would like to earn a place in a coming one.

06 THE SCHOOL NETWORK

9 schools. One room.

Hack876 begins with the schools where we already have relationships and can coordinate most reliably for the inaugural staging. Formal confirmations are still in progress, and the network is not an exclusive eligibility list.

- Hillel Academy
- Campion College
- Jamaica College
- Immaculate Conception High School
- Wolmer's
- Ardenne High School
- American International School of Kingston
- St. Andrew High School for Girls
- St. George's College

There are two natural homes for this inside AFJ.

AFJ does not conduct pre-proposal meetings, so this page is a brief interest check, not a request for one.[6]

GRANT APPLICATION

A programme grant through AFJ's annual cycle

- A short interest check now. The full case goes in the application.
- Submitted by a partner registered under the Jamaica Charities Act, or by a school through its Principal's office.
- Funds programme costs only: student meals, materials, production and recognition.
- Reported back the way AFJ asks of every grantee, every six months.

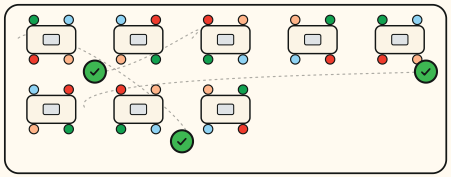
DONOR DIRECTED

A route for AFJ supporters who ask about Hack876

- AFJ also processes donor directed grants, with a one-time 5% administrative fee.
- Only if a supporter raises it. We would never approach AFJ's donors without you.
- Same registered recipient and the same reporting as a programme grant.

AFJ's contribution does not have to be purely financial.

PEOPLE IN THE ROOM.



01

Finals guest

An AFJ representative in the room for the final pitches, if the calendar allows.

02

Judge

A board or staff member on the judging panel for one track.

03

Observer

AFJ's on-site Program Analyst is welcome to watch the day from kickoff to demos.

04

Mentor

Someone from a tutoring or job-training grantee spending an hour with a team.

05

Reviewer

A quick read of our outcome measures before the day, so the report answers AFJ's questions.

GROUND RULES WE WILL HOLD OURSELVES TO

No marketing to students. AFJ appears as a supporter, never in anything pitched at them.

No student data is collected for or shared with partners. Names and photos only with school and parental consent.

Grant funds go to programme costs only, never to fundraising activities or indirect costs.

09 AUDIENCE AND BRAND VALUE

The honest answer to the visibility questions.

Will AFJ be visible? Yes, across event materials, programming and post-event storytelling, at a level that matches the partnership.

Is the audience relevant? It is the next generation of Jamaican builders, professionals and leaders, met early.

Can it build longer relationships? Yes, through people, schools and a second year, not through leads.

WHO IS IN AND AROUND THE ROOM

Ambitious secondary-school students
Approximately 80 of them, from 5th Form through Upper 6th Form.

Parents and families
Who see who showed up for their children.

Teachers and school communities
Across our network of 9 schools in Kingston.

Future university students
Making choices about what to study and where.

Future founders and professionals
Meeting AFJ early, and in the right way.

Many participants are minors. We will not promise leads, reach, impressions or data.

Become a Programme Partner of the inaugural Hack876.

J$500,000 to below J$1,000,000

PROGRAMME PARTNER · INAUGURAL HACK876

AFJ's grants typically range from US$1,000 to US$20,000. We are suggesting a contribution toward programme costs, at whatever level AFJ considers appropriate. If the timing or eligibility does not fit this cycle, a smaller grant toward food and student experience is a natural place to start.

Any amount within the level is welcome. It is a flexible contribution toward the event, with no naming rights attached.

PROPOSED RECOGNITION

The American Friends of Jamaica

Programme Partner · Inaugural Hack876

Closest Hack876 tracks: Learn, Business, Resilience

CONTRIBUTION LEVELS. ANY AMOUNT WITHIN A LEVEL IS WELCOME.

Bronze Partner	Silver Partner	Gold Partner SUGGESTED	Platinum Partner
J$50,000 to below J$200,000	J$200,000 to below J$500,000	J$500,000 to below J$1,000,000	J$1,000,000+

In-kind & Community Support: devices, gift cards, meals, refreshments, supplies, connectivity, expertise, and contributions below J$50,000.

11 CONTRIBUTION LEVELS

What each level receives.

Bronze Partner

J$50,000 to below J$200,000

- Recognition on the Hack876 website
- Included in the grouped sponsor thank-you
- Named in the post-event recap

Silver Partner

J$200,000 to below J$500,000

- Everything in Bronze
- Placement on event signage
- Acknowledgement in the opening and closing

Gold Partner

J$500,000 to below J$1,000,000

OUR SUGGESTION

- Everything in Silver
- More prominent placement
- A dedicated sponsor feature
- Logo on event shirts, if shirts are produced*

Platinum Partner

J$1,000,000+

- The most prominent sponsor placement
- An agreed opportunity to take part in the programme
- Logo on event shirts, if shirts are produced*

These are proposed benefits, to be agreed when a sponsorship is confirmed. A sponsor can contribute any amount within a band.

*Shirt placement applies only if event shirts are produced and artwork arrives before the production deadline.

Speaking, mentoring, presenting an award and judging are subject to suitability and programme capacity. Sponsorship does not buy influence over judging, and no level carries naming rights.

No contribution has to cover a whole cost.

WHAT A CONTRIBUTION COULD SUPPORT

- **Programming.** Helps support mentoring, judging and the student programme.
- **Equipment.** Helps support the equipment teams build with.
- **Materials.** Contributes toward participant materials and supplies.
- **Logistics.** Contributes toward running the day.
- **Student meals.** Contributes toward meals and refreshments on the day.

A sponsor can support the event overall, or agree a specific use with the Hack876 team. No contribution has to cover a whole cost.

AFJ does not fund grants to individuals, so a contribution would support programme costs and not student prizes.

In-kind & Community Support

For devices, gift cards, meals, refreshments, supplies, connectivity, expertise, and for contributions below J$50,000.

A meaningful in-kind contribution can be recognized at an equivalent level, based on a usable value agreed together. The advertised value of software credits or volunteer hours is not counted as cash automatically.

13 A DIRECT LINE

There is no faceless sponsorship process here.

This proposal is for **Caron Chung, Executive Director**.[1]

If AFJ is interested, we can decide together what involvement should actually look like.

QUESTIONS WE WOULD ANSWER TOGETHER

- ✓ Which registered organisation would apply, and is it registered under the Jamaica Charities Act?
- ✓ Does the event fall after AFJ's spring awards, or is this a year-two application?
- ✓ What exactly would the grant pay for, and how is that kept separate from prizes to individuals?
- ✓ How will you measure impact, and what will you report every six months?
- ✓ Who else is funding Hack876?
- ✓ Will Hack876 run again after 2027?

A conversation, not a workload.

Deliberately focused.

Our vision is national. This inaugural staging does not have national-event resources, and we will not pretend it does.

Approximately 80 students. A school network of 9 in Kingston. One day, done properly.

Build the first one well.
Learn from it.
Earn the right to make the second one bigger.

2027

Help make the first Hack876 happen.

No multi-year commitment required.

FUTURE POSSIBILITIES, ONLY IF BOTH SIDES FIND IT VALUABLE. NOT COMMITMENTS.

- A multi-school grant in a later cycle, once year one has results to report.
- Introductions to AFJ's tutoring and job-training grantees, so students have somewhere to go next.
- A challenge shaped around a community need AFJ's grantees see every day.
- Diaspora supporters giving through AFJ's donor directed route, if they ask.



HACK876 × THE AMERICAN FRIENDS OF JAMAICA

Somewhere in that room may be a future founder, engineer, designer or leader.

They do not need us to decide who they become.

They need an opportunity to begin.

HELP US BUILD THAT OPPORTUNITY.

We would love to explore whether Hack876 fits a coming grant cycle with Caron and the AFJ team.

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hack876.com info@hack876.com

SOURCES

1. The American Friends of Jamaica, "Our Team." theafj.org/our-team/

2. The American Friends of Jamaica, "About Us." theafj.org/about-us/

3. The American Friends of Jamaica, "Grants." theafj.org/grants/

4. Seprod, "Seprod Foundation and AFJ Deepen Commitment to STEAM Education Through Code Jamaica (August 11, 2025)." www.seprod.com/seprod-foundation-and-afj-deepen-commitment-to-steam-education-through-code-jamaica/

5. Jamaica Observer, "Belmont Academy, Newell High get hurricane recovery boost from AFJ (April 16, 2026)." www.jamaicaobserver.com/2026/04/16/belmont-academy-newell-high-get-hurricane-recovery-boost-afj/

6. The American Friends of Jamaica, "FAQs." theafj.org/f-a-q/

A private partnership proposal prepared for Caron Chung, Executive Director, The American Friends of Jamaica.